Zigon, Tharrawaddy soon after.[42] A police report states that he was camped there even in June 1910.[43] How successful he was in his efforts as a travelling agent is not known. It is also not known if the small collections made for the Swadeshi company in Burma in late 1909 were the result of Appadurai Iyer's exertions.[44] Somewhat later, in January 1910, one M. Ramachandra Iyer, an honorary representative of SSNCo, travelled to Singapore and Kuala Lumpur. In Singapore, he succeeded in collecting Rs 350, in addition to the Rs 350 collected earlier in November on the occasion of Deepavali.[45]

Whether all these canvassing efforts were organized or coordinated is not clear. In all likelihood, as volunteers, many of them may have worked on their own. Even if their efforts were laudable, how much they added to the company funds remains a question.

Casting the Net in Calcutta

Apart from looking for investors in the Madras Presidency, SSNCo tried to use the good offices of prominent Swadeshi leaders in Bengal to raise capital. Aurobindo's 'Diary and Almanac of 1909', notes for 20 July 1909, 3 p.m., 'Engagement with Secretary Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company'.[46] Was the appointment kept? S.D. Krishna Aiyangar was indeed in Calcutta in the first week of August,[47] but whether he met Aurobindo or what transpired in their meeting is not known.

Taking a different line, C. Vijayaraghavachari wrote to the venerable Motilal Ghose of *Amrita Bazar Patrika* (which was reporting the Swadeshi movement in Tirunelveli with great sympathy and in considerable detail) regarding support to SSNCo. Though Vijayaraghavachari's letter itself is not available, luckily, we have the reply of the latter. Motilal Ghose responded sincerely, if cautiously. Expressing happiness that the involvement of a man of Vijayaraghavachari's 'public spirit, unselfish devotion and organizing powers' was 'sure to import life & vigour into the project', he promised to put his 'humble services' at his disposal and introduce his friends 'who may render considerable help if they are so